The subsequent part contains five chapters on religious and communal disquiet in a context where hatreds have been mobilised around potent notions of 'us' and 'them'. In Chapter 12 Tamas Wells explains how we might want to sensitively and cautiously appreciate reactions to communal conflict. His chapter is followed by a quantitative analysis, authored by Bridget Welsh and Kai-Ping Huang, of public perceptions of social division based on the 2015 Myanmar Asian Barometer Survey. Matt Schissler then offers, in Chapter 14, an appreciation of Islamaphobia and holocaust denial in an effort to make sense of anti-Muslim violence. That essays leads to Gerard McCarthy's analysis of Buddhist charitable organisations in provincial areas and their role in supporting the social safety net. Then, in Chapter 16, Helal Mohammed Khan considers the profound difficulties of jointly managing the Myanmar–Bangladesh borderlands, the site of so much of the region's recent heartache.

In the concluding chapter, my co-editor, Nick Cheesman, explains the variety of ways that we should think about political activity. His critique offers guidance on some of the further developments that may emerge in social scientific analysis of conflict and politics in Myanmar. As his intervention suggests, there is no sense in which any of these observations on recent history are the final word. Life in Myanmar continues to change rapidly, and the NLD-led government that took power in 2016 is now forced into a novel set of negotiations with the remnants of the former military regime. The military itself — for so long a principal actor in war, politics, and religion — is adjusting to the contested political landscape. For once, there is hope that deft policy-making and implementation will bring Myanmar's sad history of violent conflict to a close. If that proves a sustainable result, the country's political institutions will have changed in many ways. The chapters in this volume identify both the lingering problems and the enticing possibilities of a more peaceful tomorrow.

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